Facebook/Meta API Verification

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Facebook / Meta API Verification Guide

Date: February 8, 2026 **Platform:** Facebook & Meta Developer Platform **Portal:** https://developers.facebook.com/

📋 Overview

This guide describes the complete verification process to obtain API access for Facebook and Meta's developer platform. This process is also required for Instagram API access.

🎯 What You Need

For Business Verification:

- ✅ Business documentation (business registration, business license)
- ✅ Business email address (preferably with own domain)
- ✅ Company website
- ✅ Business phone number

For App Review:

- ✅ Working prototype of your application
- ✅ Test credentials for reviewers
- ✅ Video walkthroughs (screen recordings)
- ✅ Detailed use case descriptions

📝 Step 1: Business Verification

Why Business Verification?

IMPORTANT: Business Verification is **MANDATORY** for Advanced Access (full API functionality).

- **Standard Access:** Very limited, only own accounts, strict rate limits → **UNUSABLE for production**
- **Advanced Access:** Full functionality → **Requires Business Verification + App Review**

Process

1. **Go to Facebook Developer Portal**
   - URL: https://developers.facebook.com/
   - Log in with your Facebook account
2. **Select Your App**
   - Go to "My Apps"
   - Select existing app or create new app
3. **Start Business Verification**
   - Click "Business Verification" in left menu
   - Or go via App Settings → Basic → Business Verification
4. **Upload Documentation**

   Acceptable documents:

   - Business registration certificate
   - Business license
   - Tax registration documents
   - Articles of incorporation

   Important tips:

- ✅ Documents must be recent (< 6 months old)
- ✅ Business name must **exactly** match across all documents
- ✅ Upload clear scans (no poor smartphone photos)
- ✅ Use business email with own domain (@company.com, NOT @gmail.com)

5. **Wait for Approval**

- **Timeline:** 3-7 days
- You'll receive email upon approval/rejection
- If rejected: improve documentation and resubmit

⚠️ Alternative: Individual Verification

If you don't have a business, you can apply for Individual Verification:

Process: 1. Select "Individual Verification" 2. Enter email address to receive contract 3. Upload ID (passport, driver's license, national ID) 4. Sign contract

WARNING: - ❌ Certain permissions are limited or unavailable - ❌ Not suitable for apps with many users - ❌ Not suitable for production environments - ✅ Only for personal/hobby projects

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🎬 Step 2: App Review - Request Permissions

After Business Verification, you can request permissions (API access rights).

Important Facebook Permissions

Permission	Description	Use Case
`pages_manage_posts`	Post to Facebook Pages	Content scheduling, social media management
`pages_read_engagement`	Page analytics	Fetch statistics, measure engagement
`pages_show_list`	List of managed Pages	Select Pages for posting
`public_profile`	Basic user info	Login, identification
`email`	User email address	Account linking

Important Instagram Permissions (via Meta)

Permission	Description	Use Case
`instagram_basic`	Profile info + media	Basic Instagram account access
`instagram_content_publish`	Publish content	Post photos, videos, stories
`instagram_manage_comments`	Manage comments	Reply to comments, moderation
`instagram_manage_insights`	Analytics	Statistics and insights

🎥 Creating Video Walkthroughs (REQUIRED)

For **EVERY** permission you request, you must create a video walkthrough.

What Should It Include?

1. **Complete User Flow**
   - User logs in with Facebook/Instagram
   - User grants permission (OAuth consent screen)
   - App uses the access (show exactly where data appears)
2. **Data Usage**
   - Show precisely which data you fetch
   - Show where data is stored
   - Demonstrate how user can delete data
3. **Security & Privacy**
   - Show HTTPS connection
   - Display privacy policy
   - Demonstrate data encryption (if applicable)

Technical Requirements

- ✅ **Max length:** 10 minutes per permission
- ✅ **Format:** MP4, MOV, or AVI
- ✅ **Quality:** Screen recording is sufficient (no high production value needed)
- ✅ **Audio:** No voice-over or music needed
- ❌ **Test data:** Use test accounts, NO real user data

📤 App Review Submission

Process

1. **Go to App Review**
   - In your app dashboard: “App Review” → “Permissions and Features”
2. **Request Permissions**
   - Click “+ Request Advanced Access”
   - Select desired permissions
3. **For Each Permission:**

   a) Upload Video Walkthrough

   - Upload your screen recording
   - Max 10 minutes per permission

   b) Describe Use Case

   - Why do you need this permission?

- How is the data used?
- How long do you store data?
- Is data shared with third parties?

c) Provide Test Credentials

- Username + password for test account
- Step-by-step instructions for reviewers
- Ensure test account has full access

4. **Submit for Review**

- Review everything
- Click "Submit"
- Wait for approval

Review Timeline

Duration: 2-14 days

⏱️ Complete Timeline

Phase	Duration	Status Tracking
Business Verification	3-7 days	Email notifications
App Review	2-14 days	Dashboard → App Review → Status
Total	**5-21 days**	-

🚨 Common Mistakes

❌ Mistake 1: Using Standard Access

Problem: Standard Access is too limited for production **Solution:** Always request Advanced Access via App Review

❌ Mistake 2: Requesting Too Many Permissions

Problem: More permissions = slower review + higher rejection chance **Solution:** Request ONLY permissions you truly need

❌ Mistake 3: Poor Video Walkthroughs

Problem: Unclear videos lead to rejection **Solution:** Test your video before submitting (show to colleague)

❌ Mistake 4: No Test Credentials

Problem: Reviewers cannot test app **Solution:** Create dedicated test account with full access

❌ Mistake 5: Outdated Business Documents

Problem: Documents older than 6 months are rejected **Solution:** Download recent business registration certificate

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📞 Support & Help

Facebook Developer Support: - https://developers.facebook.com/support/ - Community Forum: https://developers.facebook.com/community/

App Review Status: - Check in App Dashboard → App Review

✅ Checklist

For Business Verification:

- [ ] Recent business registration (< 6 months)
- [ ] Business email with own domain
- [ ] Business website online and functional
- [ ] Business phone number

For App Review:

- [ ] Working prototype of app
- [ ] For each permission: video walkthrough (< 10 min)
- [ ] Test account with full access
- [ ] Detailed use case descriptions
- [ ] Privacy policy publicly available
- [ ] Security measures implemented (HTTPS, encryption)

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